

Down the Rabbit-Hole

How curiosity led Alice into a world of strange logic

Bored on a riverbank, Alice spots a White Rabbit with a pocket watch, muttering that it is late. Curiosity gets the better of her, and she follows it down a rabbit-hole — tumbling into a slow, strange fall and a hall of locked doors that will not let her into the garden she longs to reach.

1

A Curious Rabbit

A White Rabbit runs past checking a pocket watch, worried about being late. Alice, astonished a rabbit could own one, chases it down a hole without a thought for how she'll get back out.

2

The Endless Fall

She drifts slowly down a deep, well-like shaft lined with cupboards and shelves, even pausing to take a jar of orange marmalade — empty — from a shelf as she passes.

3

A Hall of Locked Doors

She lands unhurt in a long hall lined with locked doors, with no way through — until she spots a tiny golden key on a glass table.

4

The Tiny Door

The key opens a fifteen-inch door revealing a beautiful garden — but Alice is far too big to fit through, even with her head.

5

"Drink Me"

A bottle labelled "DRINK ME" appears on the table. Alice checks it isn't marked poison, tastes it, and shrinks to just ten inches tall.

6

A Key Out of Reach

Now too small to reach the key she left on the table, Alice cries in frustration before scolding herself back into action.

7

"Eat Me"

She finds a small cake marked "EAT ME" and eats it, hoping it will change her size again — whichever way, so she can reach the garden.

THE TAKEAWAY

In one chapter, Alice's unchecked curiosity carries her from the ordinary world into a place ruled by strange, arbitrary rules — setting the pattern of transformation and problem-solving that drives the rest of her adventures in Wonderland.